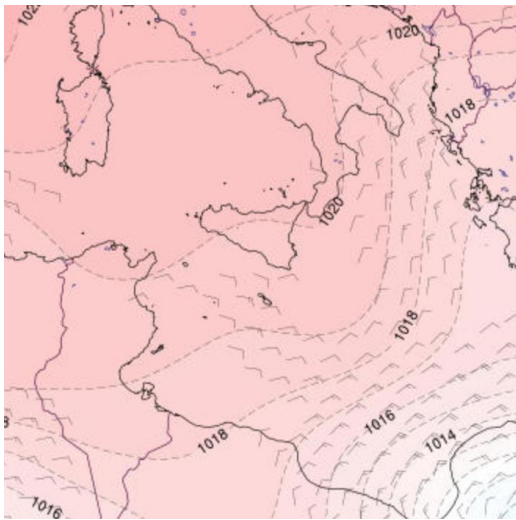


Date: October 19th , 2018
Time: 08:20 AM (06:20 UTC)
Event: Middle Sea Race
Team: Power Play

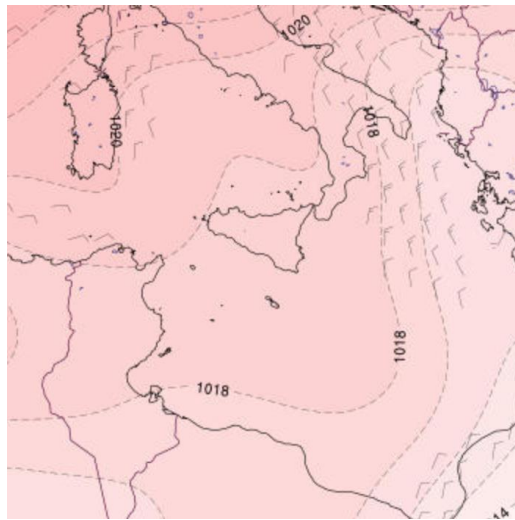


Synopsis: Blocking High covering from Açores to Scandinavia. Low pressures around Turkey and the Eastern Med, weak on the weekend but deepening and moving closer on Monday and Tuesday.

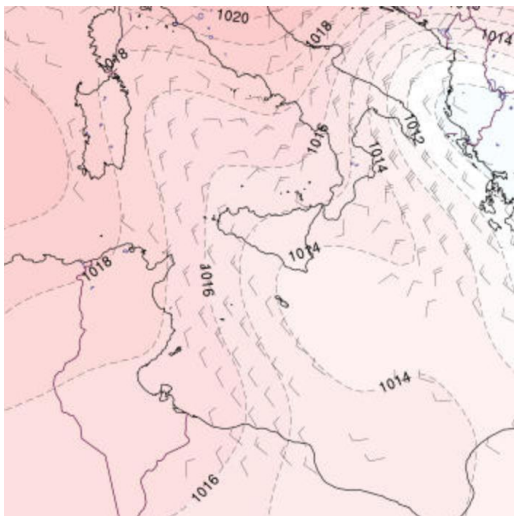
In terms of wind, this leads to a quite slow first leg up to Messina, with light gradient, maybe playing with local winds, then the northerly gradient will fill in moderate to fresh.



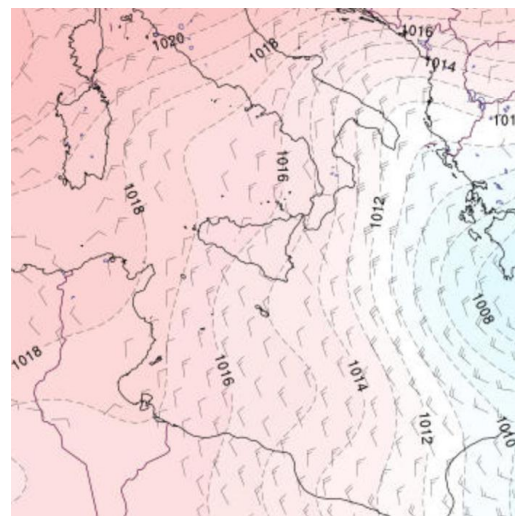
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sat 20th



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sun 21st



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Mon 22nd



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Tue 23rd

WARNINGS: Nil.

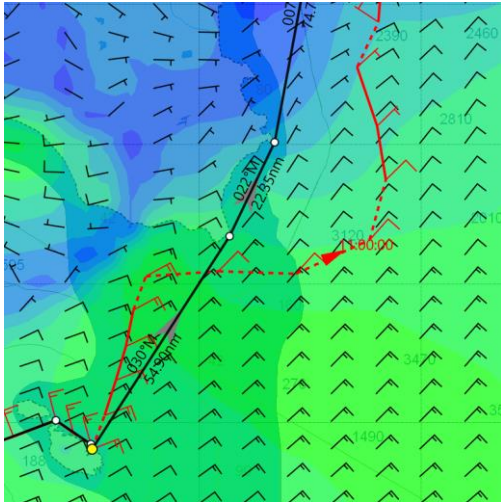
Weather Conditions: There is some instability around tomorrow and on Sunday, but mostly sunny sky most of the time, some slight chance of an isolated shower.
Sea Surface Temperature around 22° C.

Forecast along the course

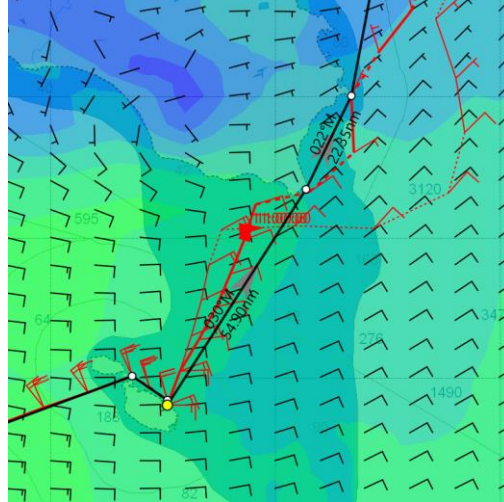
We'll run the routings with Arpege and Lamma 9km for Saturday and Sunday, then for the long term the GFS routing compared with the EC scenario.

Malta to Capo Passero and Siracusa

Initial gradient from the NE, 14-16 kts bending and veering slightly in the afternoon with the Sicilian Thermal, easing/dropping in the evening/early night close to the land. Stronger breeze initially than the expected yesterday, so we could either go offshore looking for stronger gradient, or stay close to shore for local acceleration and bending.



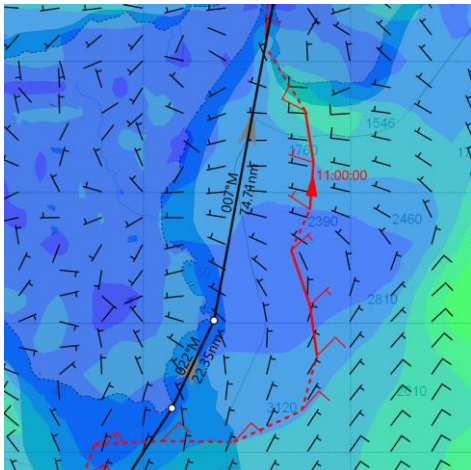
Arpege 14 h



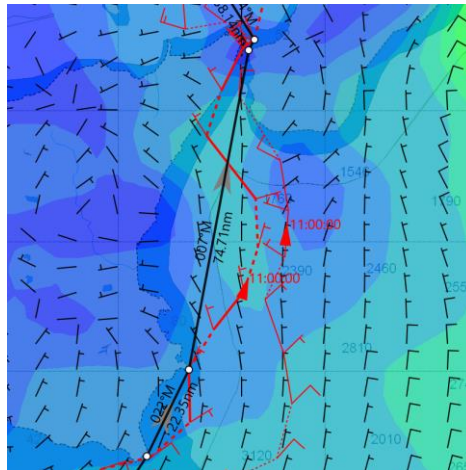
Lamma 14 h

Siracusa to Messina Strait

The N-NE gradient apparently remains to the West, today models are more consistent on a N/NW wind in the Strait in the early morning; there can be a tricky light transition between both wind patterns.

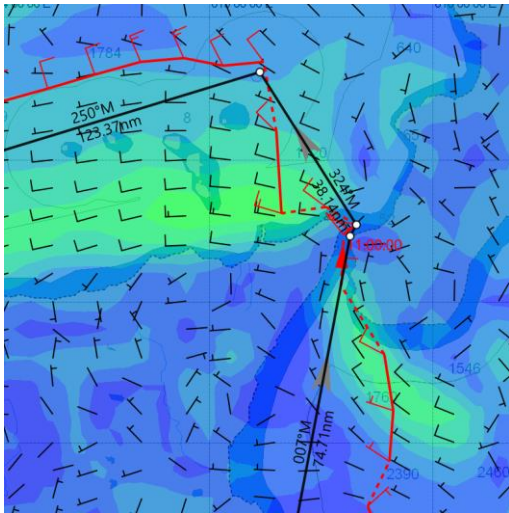


Arpege Sun 02 h

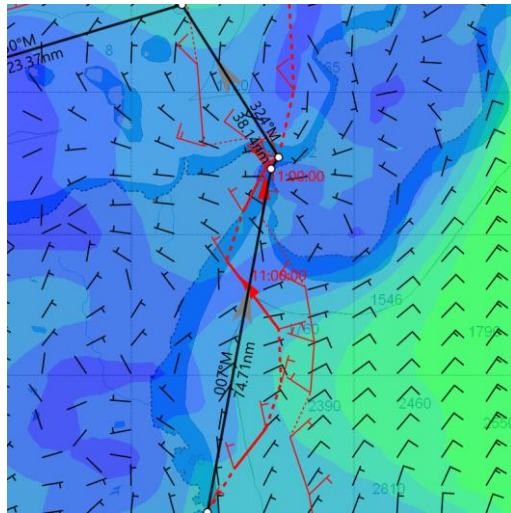


Lamma Sun 02 h

Northerly in the Strait bending around the Italian coastline, speed gentle to moderate 7-13 kts. Much faster route than we expected yesterday.



Arpege Sun 08 h



Lamma Sun 08 h

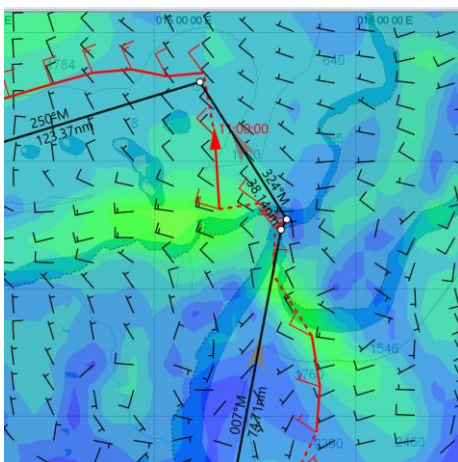
Arpege shows crossing the Strait around 10 h in the morning, so against the current from 0630 to 1240 h, Lamma at 13 h when the *montante* filling in.

Southwards current (*scendente*) between 0630 h and 1240 h
Northwards current (*montante*) between 1240 and 1840 h. (Sunday 21st)
Southwards current (*scendente*) between 1840 h and 0125 h
Northwards current (*montante*) between 0125 and 0710 h. (Monday 22nd)

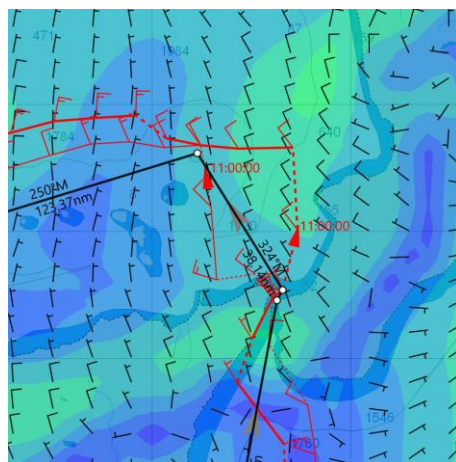
As always, this first part of the race can be quite critical, small timing differences can mean you face a the *Montante* o *scendente* causing huge differences.

Strait to Stromboli

Not totally consistent, but mainly N or NW gentle to moderate gradient on the way to Stromboli, it can be a beat in 8-13 kts by the moment, we'll see tomorrow the strategies. Timings at Stromboli are 16 h (Arpege), 19-20 h (Lamma).



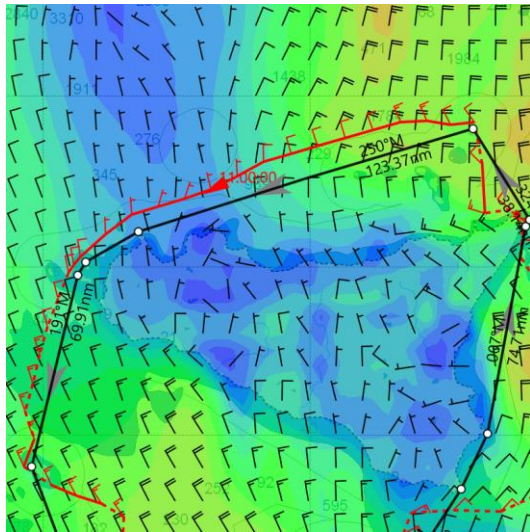
Arpege 14 h Sunday



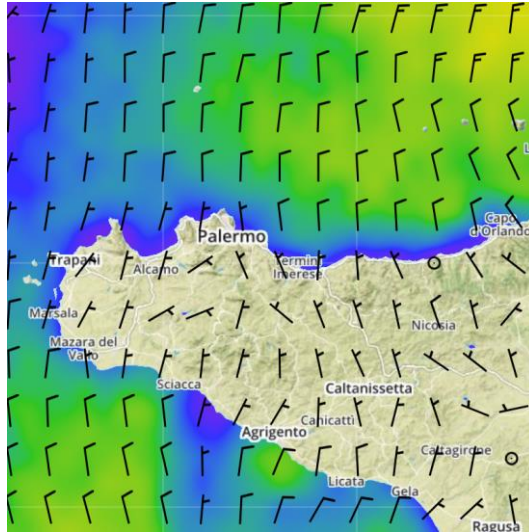
Lamma 15 h Sunday

Stromboli to Finish

So we can assume rounding Stromboli on Sunday afternoon, let's see the global models scenario the following hours. Mainly a Beam reach on the long leg, moderate speeds, but there can be a lighter period at night reaching San Vito lo Capo,

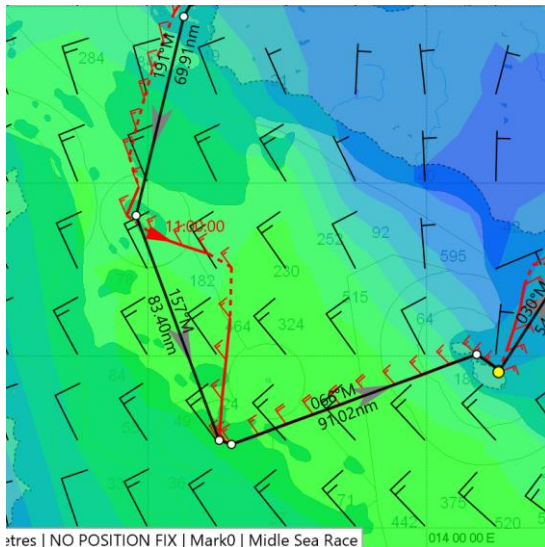


Arpege 23 h Sunday

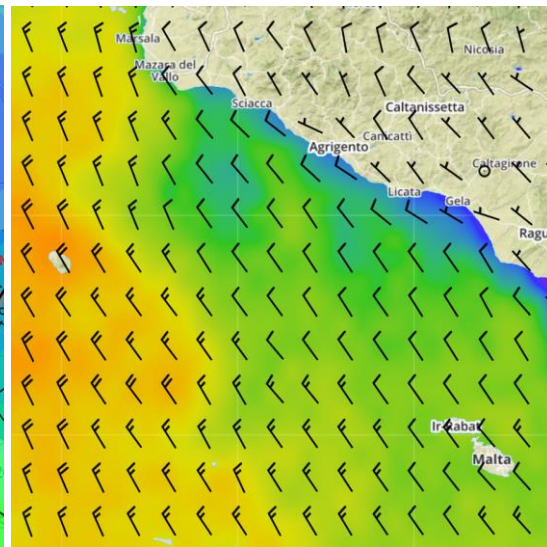


EC 23 h

Let's assume reaching San Vito in the early morning, increasing breeze 10-15 kts, open reach getting to Pantelleria around 10 h,

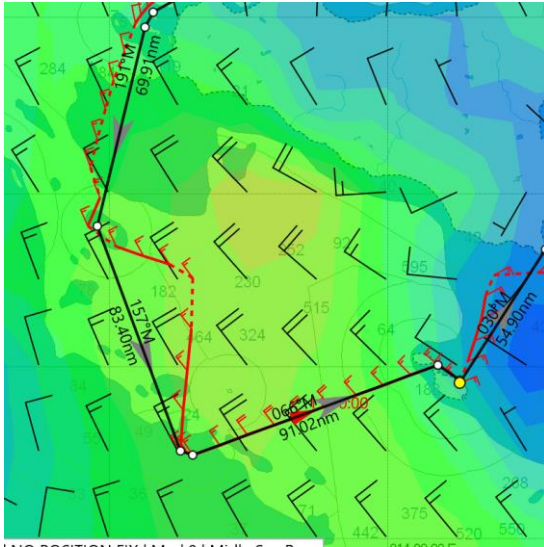


GFS Monday 11 h

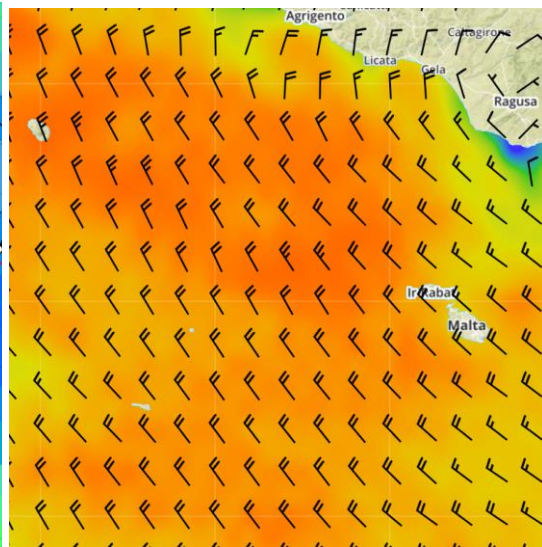


EC Monday 11 h

Then a run in increasing breeze to Lampedusa; final leg a beam reach in 20-25 kts wind from NW on Monday afternoon (can be a bit stronger).



GFS Monday 17 h



EC 17 h